



Bank Alfalah

ALFA LEAD **ASSESSMENT** **CENTER**

ASSESSOR GUIDE

The Bank Alfalah Experience Center

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WHAT PARTICIPANTS ARE REQUIRED TO PRODUCE

1. Physical Prototype — a scaled-down model of their Experience Center using provided materials, clearly showing all five mandatory zones: Welcome Zone, Self-Service Hub, Advisory Lounge, Digital Experience Wall, and Customer Flow.
2. Operational Feasibility Model (on paper/chart sheet) — a hand-drawn or written analysis covering: Operational Feasibility (staffing, training needs, technology risk, peak-hour handling), Customer Feasibility (who uses it, which segments, adoption likelihood), Scalability Logic (Tier 1 vs Tier 2 cities, standardization vs customization), and Risk & Failure Points (where queues, friction, or breakdowns will emerge).
3. Final Pitch — a 10-minute walkthrough presented to assessors as if to the CEO, covering both the physical model and the feasibility model.

Mid-Build Constraints

The constraints below are to be introduced by the facilitator during the Build Phase. They serve as deliberate disruptions to test participants' problem-solving ability, adaptability, and commitment to process improvement under pressure.

IMPORTANT NOTES FOR CONSTRAINTS

Not all 10 constraints will be used. The facilitator will introduce only a few of them.

Constraints can be introduced at different intervals and do not need to follow the order listed below.

Participants have **not** been informed that mid-build constraints will be introduced. They should refer to their participant brief only for context on the round format.

CONSTRAINT 1 SPACE REDUCTION

"Your allocated space has just been cut by 30%. Adjust your model accordingly."

OBSERVE:

- ▶ Does the team stay calm or does panic set in? Who takes the lead?
- ▶ Do they reprioritize zones logically, or do they randomly trim?
- ▶ Does the feasibility model get updated to reflect the change?
- ▶ Does anyone advocate for protecting customer-critical zones (e.g., the Advisory Lounge)?

CONSTRAINT 2 BUDGET SHOCK

"You have just lost PKR 500 from your remaining material budget. Reconsider your planned purchases."

OBSERVE:

- ▶ Does the team conduct a rational cost-benefit review, or do they panic-cut?
- ▶ Who is tracking the budget? Is there a clear CFO-type role in the team?
- ▶ Do they sacrifice aesthetics (LED, logos) before functionality (zones, flow)?

CONSTRAINT 3 PEAK HOUR SURGE

"New data shows that at least 40% of your daily customers will arrive in a single 1-hour window. Your design must handle this."

OBSERVE:

- ▶ Do they redesign the customer flow or simply add more staff on paper?
- ▶ Is the Self-Service Hub expanded or the Advisory Lounge adjusted?
- ▶ Does the feasibility model address peak-hour handling strategy?
- ▶ Do they think about queue management, digital deflection, or appointment booking?

CONSTRAINT 4 STAFF CUT

"Your staffing plan has been revised. You can only hire 60% of the staff you originally planned. Adjust accordingly."

OBSERVE:

- ▶ Do they redesign roles for multi-tasking (hybrid advisory + service staff)?
- ▶ Is self-service technology expanded to compensate?
- ▶ Does the feasibility model's staffing section get revised?
- ▶ Do they consider training implications for a smaller but broader-skilled team?

CONSTRAINT 5 POWER OUTAGE RISK

"Your risk team has flagged that digital systems in this location will be offline for approximately 20% of operating hours. Your center must still function."

OBSERVE:

- ▶ Do they build analog fallbacks into the design (manual forms, paper tokens)?
- ▶ Is the Digital Experience Wall rethought for non-digital hours?
- ▶ Does the feasibility model address technology dependency risks?
- ▶ Do they distinguish between must-run digital processes vs nice-to-have ones?

CONSTRAINT 6 ELDERLY ACCESSIBILITY REQUIREMENT

"A regulatory directive has been issued: your Experience Center must fully support customers who are non-digital and low-tech — including elderly and mobility-impaired visitors."

OBSERVE:

- ▶ Is the Welcome Zone updated for accessibility (ramps, large print, human greeters)?
- ▶ Is a dedicated low-tech service counter added, or do they retrofit existing zones?
- ▶ Does inclusivity reflect in the physical model (wider paths, seating, visible staff)?
- ▶ Does the feasibility model address which customer segments benefit most vs least?

CONSTRAINT 7 VIP SURGE

"Market intelligence suggests a sudden increase in high-net-worth and priority banking customers in this area. Your center must accommodate their need for privacy and premium service."

OBSERVE:

- ▶ Do they add a private or semi-private zone within the Advisory Lounge?
- ▶ Is a VIP entrance or dedicated flow path considered?
- ▶ Does the team think about how VIP experience and mass-market experience coexist?
- ▶ Is there a risk of the Experience Center feeling exclusionary to regular customers?

CONSTRAINT 8 REGULATORY AUDIT

"The Compliance team has issued a mandate: every customer transaction in this center must have a traceable compliance record — paper or digital proof at every touchpoint."

OBSERVE:

- ▶ Is a compliance trace built into every zone (receipts, logs, ID verification points)?
- ▶ Does the flow account for added time per transaction due to compliance steps?
- ▶ Does the feasibility model's risk section address audit readiness?
- ▶ Do they think about who owns compliance at each stage — staff or system?

CONSTRAINT 9 ZERO WAIT TIME MANDATE

"Senior leadership has set a service standard: no customer should wait more than 5 minutes at any point in their journey. Revisit your design."

OBSERVE:

- ▶ Is the customer flow redrawn to eliminate any single-point bottleneck?
- ▶ Does appointment booking, digital queue management, or pre-registration get introduced?
- ▶ Is the Self-Service Hub prioritized for volume relief?
- ▶ Does the feasibility model address peak-hour handling in light of this constraint?

CONSTRAINT 10 BRANCH SHUTDOWN SIMULATION

"Emergency scenario: one full zone in your Experience Center has been closed due to an unforeseen issue. The remaining zones must absorb all functionality. Which zone closes, and how do you adapt?"

OBSERVE:

- ▶ Does the team select the zone to close strategically (least critical), or randomly?
- ▶ Can the remaining zones realistically absorb the closed zone's function?
- ▶ Is the customer journey rerouted clearly in the physical model?
- ▶ Does the feasibility model's Risk & Failure Points section reflect this scenario?

What to Assess During the Final Pitch

Each team's pitch should be walked through as if the CEO is being presented to for investment approval. As an assessor, you are evaluating the quality of thinking behind the model, not just how polished it looks.

Physical Model Walkthrough

- Are all five zones present and clearly labeled?
- Is the customer flow logical and clearly shown (arrows, string, markers)?
- Has the model been adapted to reflect any constraints that were introduced?
- Does the physical model feel customer-centric or institution-centric?

Operational Feasibility Model

- Is staffing considered realistically (numbers, roles, training needs for hybrid advisory staff)?
- Are technology dependency risks acknowledged (e.g., what happens if the system goes down)?
- Is there a peak-hour handling strategy — appointment systems, digital deflection, queue management?
- Have they thought about who will actually use this and which segments may not adopt it?
- Do they distinguish between Tier 1 and Tier 2 city viability? Can this model be standardized?
- Have they identified their own risk and failure points honestly, or does the model present a best-case-only view?

Constraint Integration

- Does the team clearly explain how they adapted to the constraints that were introduced?
- Is the constraint response reflected in both the physical model and the feasibility model?
- Did any individual demonstrate strong leadership during a constraint moment — note them by name.

Risk, Failure & Financial Probing Questions

Use these questions during or after the pitch to test how deeply participants have thought about real-world viability. These are not meant to trip candidates up — they are designed to reveal depth of thinking, commercial awareness, and the ability to think on their feet.

1. If your main technology vendor goes bankrupt tomorrow and all your kiosks and screens stop working, how does this center continue to serve customers?
2. A major security incident occurs at the center — an armed robbery attempt or a data breach at one of the self-service kiosks. What's your contingency plan, and how do you restore customer confidence?
3. Three months after launch, customer footfall is 40% below your projection. What do you change? What do you double down on?
4. What is your estimated total capital investment to build one Experience Center from scratch? Walk me through the major cost buckets.
5. Assuming the center is profitable after Year 1, where would you recommend re-investing the profits — more centers, better technology in this one, or something else? Why?
6. A viral social media post claims your center is 'unfriendly to elderly customers.' It gets 50,000 shares. What's your response — operationally and in terms of communications?